

Avoid unnecessary repeated moves

Opening Decisions

THE IDEA

Repeated moves by one piece consume time that might develop the rest of your army. This matters most when the center can open. Repeat a move when a concrete threat or gain justifies it, not because you have run out of ideas.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A bishop chased twice by pawn moves may cost tempi, but those pawn moves also leave weaknesses. Decide whether keeping the bishop's pressure is worth the time and whether you can exploit the new pawn structure.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

When is retreating a developed piece the right choice?

ANSWER AND REASONING

When it is attacked, badly placed, or needed for a sound plan. The goal is useful coordination, so preserving an active piece can outweigh a general development guideline.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Account for lost time without becoming a prisoner of slogans.